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# Sport Fishing Licenses and Report Cards



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## Sport Fishing Items and Fees

Purchase these items [ONLINE](#) or at any [LICENSE AGENT](#) or [CDFW LICENSE SALES OFFICE](#).

**Note:** The California Department of Fish and Wildlife (CDFW) does not accept cash at CDFW's License and Revenue Branch and regional license counters. Individuals who want to make payments at CDFW's License and Revenue Branch or a regional license counter can use checks, money orders, or any debit/credit card with the Visa or Mastercard logo.

A resident is any person who has resided continuously in the State of California for six months or more immediately prior to the date of their application for a license or permit, any person on active military duty with the Armed Forces of the United States or auxiliary branch thereof, or any person enrolled in the Job Corps.

Most fees include 5% license agent handling fee and 3% nonrefundable application fee.

## 365-Day Sport Fishing Licenses

(valid for 365 days from the date of purchase)

*A sport fishing license is required for any person attempting to take fish, mollusks, crustaceans, invertebrates, amphibians, or reptiles in inland or ocean waters. Additional validations and report cards are required for certain species and areas.*

| Title                               | 2026 Fee        | Description                                                                                          |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Resident Sport Fishing              | \$64.54         | Available for any resident 16 years of age or older.                                                 |
| Nonresident Sport Fishing           | \$174.14        | Available for any non-resident 16 years of age or older.                                             |
| Reduced-Fee Sport Fishing License - | \$10.04 at CDFW | Available for any resident or nonresident honorably discharged disabled veteran with a 50 percent or |

|                                                                                   |                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Disabled Veteran                                                                  | Offices<br>\$10.54 from<br>License<br>Agents                       | greater service-connected disability. After you <a href="#">prequalify for your first Disabled Veteran Reduced Fee Sport Fishing License</a> , you can purchase disabled veteran licenses anywhere licenses are sold.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Reduced-Fee Sport Fishing License – Recovering Service Member                     | \$10.04 at<br>CDFW<br>Offices<br>\$10.54 from<br>License<br>Agents | Available for any recovering service member of the US military. After you <a href="#">prequalify for your Recovering Service Member Reduced-Fee Sport Fishing License</a> , you can purchase recovering service member licenses anywhere licenses are sold.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Reduced Fee Sport Fishing License - Low Income Senior                             | \$10.04                                                            | <b>ATTENTION!</b> The eligibility requirements for low income seniors to obtain a reduced-fee sport fishing license have changed. Effective January 1, 2022, reduced-fee sport fishing licenses will be available for low-income California residents, 65 years of age and older, who receive Supplemental Security Income (SSI) or Cash Assistance Program for Aged, Blind, and Disabled Legal Immigrants (CAPI). The <a href="#">Reduced-Fee Sport Fishing License for Low Income Seniors</a> is only available at <a href="#">CDFW License Sales Offices</a> . |
| Free Sport Fishing License - Low Income Native American                           | NO FEE                                                             | Available for any Native American who is a resident of the State and is financially unable to pay the fee required for a resident sport fishing license. Your first <a href="#">Free Sport Fishing License for Low Income Native Americans</a> must be obtained from the <a href="#">CDFW License and Revenue Branch</a> . Subsequent licenses may be obtained from a <a href="#">CDFW License Sales Office</a> or <a href="#">online</a> <a href="#">↗</a> . See <a href="#">application</a> <a href="#">↗</a> for details.                                      |
| Free Sport Fishing License - Mobility Impaired, Blind or Developmentally Disabled | NO FEE                                                             | Available for a person who is blind, developmentally disabled, or mobility impaired. Your first <a href="#">Free Sport Fishing License</a> must be obtained from the CDFW License and Revenue Branch. Subsequent licenses may be obtained from any license agent. See <a href="#">application</a> for details.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |

## Short Term Sport Fishing Licenses

| Title                                     | 2026 Fee | Description                                                                                                                                                     |
|-------------------------------------------|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| One-day Sport Fishing License             | \$21.09  | Allows a resident or nonresident to fish for one specified day. One-day sport fishing licenses are exempt from the Ocean Enhancement Validation requirement.    |
| Two-day Sport Fishing License             | \$32.40  | Allows a resident or nonresident to fish for two consecutive days. Two-day sport fishing licenses are exempt from the Ocean Enhancement Validation requirement. |
| Ten-day Nonresident Sport Fishing License | \$64.54  | Allows a nonresident to fish for ten consecutive days.                                                                                                          |

## Validations and Report Cards

Report cards are required for any person fishing for steelhead, sturgeon, abalone, spiny lobster, or salmon (salmon in the Klamath, Trinity and Smith Rivers only). Every person fishing for these species must have an appropriate report card, including any person who is not required to have a sport fishing license, such as a child who is under 16 years of age, a person who is fishing from a public pier, and any person who is fishing on a free fishing day.

| Title                                                            | 2026 Fee | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ocean Enhancement Validation                                     | \$7.30   | Required to fish in ocean waters south of Point Arguello (Santa Barbara County). An Ocean Enhancement Validation is not required when fishing under the authority of a One or Two-Day Sport Fishing License.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Second Rod Validation                                            | \$20.26  | Allows a person to fish with two rods or lines in inland waters, except for waters in which only artificial lures or barbless hooks may be used.<br><b>Note: A Second Rod Validation is not required when fishing in ocean waters as defined in CCR, Title 14, Section 27.00.</b><br>For general fishing gear restrictions in ocean waters, please refer to CCR, Title 14, Section 28.65. These sections can be found in the <a href="#">Saltwater Sport Fishing Regulations Booklet</a> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Recreational Crab Trap Validation                                | \$2.98   | Required for any person taking crabs with crab traps as defined in CCR, T14, Section 29.80(c). When taking crabs with hoop nets or crab loop traps, this validation is not required.<br><b>ATTENTION:</b> Beginning January 1, 2026, anglers fishing for crabs using crab trap(s) from a Commercial Passenger Fishing Vessel are no longer required to possess this validation.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Abalone Report Card                                              | N/A      | <b>Fishery is currently closed.</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Sturgeon Fishing Report Card                                     | \$8.13   | Required for any person taking sturgeon. Catch-and-release only.<br><b>ATTENTION:</b> New sturgeon regulations went into effect on September 26, 2025.<br><br>Catch-and-release fishing for white sturgeon will continue to be available for anglers under the new regulations. Sturgeon report cards for the 2025 calendar year that have already been purchased will remain valid until December 31, 2025.<br><br>Anglers may obtain a 2025-2026 Sturgeon Report Card at no cost beginning September 27, 2025. Sturgeon report cards for the 2026-2027 season will cost \$8.13.<br><br>For more information, including reporting requirements and dates, please visit:<br><br><a href="#">News Release: White Sturgeon Opener Kicks Off with a No-Fee Report Card for This Season</a> |
| North Coast Salmon Report Card                                   | \$9.21   | Required for any person taking salmon in the Smith River System or Klamath-Trinity River System.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Steelhead Report Card                                            | \$10.29  | Required for any person taking steelhead in inland waters.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Spiny Lobster Report Card (valid for the entire lobster season). | \$12.70  | Required for all persons taking spiny lobster. Report card holders who fail to return their Spiny Lobster Report Card or report their harvest online by April 30, will be assessed a \$21.60 non-return fee when they purchase a spiny lobster report card for the following season.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |

## Lifetime Fishing Licenses

| License Package           | 2026 Fee   | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|---------------------------|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ages 0-9                  | \$709.00   | Available to residents of California. Lifetime fishing licenses are valid for 365 days from the date of issuance. Lifetime Fishing Packages must first be purchased from a <a href="#">CDFW License Sales Office</a> . See <a href="#">Lifetime License Information</a> for more detail. |
| Ages 10-39                | \$1,160.25 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Ages 40-61                | \$1,045.00 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Ages 62+                  | \$709.00   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Fishing Privilege Package | \$478.75   | Includes a Lifetime Second-Rod Validation, Ocean Enhancement Validation, North Coast Salmon Report Card and Steelhead Report Card. The Second-Rod Validation and Ocean Enhancement Validation are valid for 365 days from the date of issuance.                                          |

## Duplicate Fees

| Title                                                      | 2026 Fee | Description                                                                                                                    |
|------------------------------------------------------------|----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Duplicate Sport Fishing License                            | \$14.30  | Replaces a lost or stolen sport fishing license.                                                                               |
| Second-Rod and Ocean Enhancement Sport Fishing Validations | \$3.81   | Replaces a lost or stolen second-rod or ocean enhancement sport fishing validation.                                            |
| Recreational Crab Trap Sport Fishing Validation            | \$2.98   | Replaces a lost or stolen recreational crab trap sport fishing validation.                                                     |
| Abalone Report Card                                        | N/A      | <b>Fishery is currently closed.</b> Replaces lost or stolen Abalone Report Card. Available only at CDFW license sales offices. |

## Online Reporting of Fishing Harvest

[REPORT YOUR HARVEST](#)

After logging into the Online License Service, select HARVEST REPORTING and follow the instructions to report your harvest.

## Online Reporting Availability

| Harvest Report Type       | Reporting Dates         | Late Reporting*      | Program Information                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|---------------------------|-------------------------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Abalone Report Card       | December 1 - January 31 | February 1 - April 1 | <a href="#">Abalone</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Spiny Lobster Report Card | March 19 - April 30     | May 1 - July 1       | <a href="#">Spiny Lobster</a><br><b>Report cardholders who fail to return their Full Season Spiny Lobster Report Card or report their harvest online by April 30, following the close of lobster season, will be assessed a \$21.60 non-return fee when they purchase a spiny lobster report card for the following season.</b> |

|                                |                        |                      |                           |
|--------------------------------|------------------------|----------------------|---------------------------|
| North Coast Salmon Report Card | January 1 - January 31 | February 1 - April 1 | <a href="#">Salmon</a>    |
| Steelhead Report Card          | January 1 - January 31 | February 1 - April 1 | <a href="#">Steelhead</a> |
| Sturgeon Fishing Report Card   | January 1 - January 31 | February 1 - April 1 | <a href="#">Sturgeon</a>  |

\* Late reporting occurs after the regulatory deadline.

**If you have not reported your harvest by the dates listed above, please mail your harvest report card to the address listed on the report card immediately.**

## Free and Reduced-Fee Sport Fishing Licenses

To qualify for a Free or Reduced-Fee Sport Fishing License, anglers must meet the criteria described below.

### Disabled Veteran Sport Fishing License – Fee \$10.54

Reduced-fee licenses are available for any honorably discharged veteran of the US Armed Forces with a service-connected disability rating of 50% or greater.

To prequalify to purchase a disabled veteran license, submit a letter from the Veteran's Administration documenting that you were honorably discharged from the US military and have a service-connected disability rating of 50% or greater. After your eligibility has been verified, your customer record will be updated. Once you receive notification from the Department that your customer record has been updated, you will be able to purchase a low cost disabled veteran sport fishing license and/or hunting license anywhere licenses are sold.

Please visit the [U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs](#) website to obtain a copy of your VA Benefit Summary Letter that includes your character of discharge and combined service-connected evaluation rating.

### Recovering Service Member Sport Fishing License - Fee \$10.54

Reduced-fee sport fishing licenses are available for recovering service members. A recovering service member is a member of the Armed Forces, including a member of the National Guard or a Reserve, who is undergoing medical treatment, recuperation, or therapy and is in an outpatient status while recovering from a serious injury or illness related to the member's military service.

Submit a letter from your commanding officer or from a military medical doctor verifying your eligibility as a recovering service member. Please have your commanding officer or military medical doctor include the expected recovery date in your verification letter. The Department will enter this date into your customer profile and allow you to renew your license until this date without submitting another letter from your commanding officer or doctor.

### How to Prequalify for a Disabled Veteran or Recovering Service Member License

Send a photocopy of your identification and documentation of eligibility by:

- Upload via your customer record through the [CDFW Online License Sales and Services website](#)

- Mail to any [CDFW license sales office](#)
- Fax at (916) 419-7585
- Secure document upload - To upload your documentation, you must request a secure document upload. Send your request for a secure document upload to [LRB@wildlife.ca.gov](mailto:LRB@wildlife.ca.gov). You will receive a response with a link to upload your documentation securely. **DO NOT** send your documents via email.

**Include:**

- Identification -
  - Your driver's license; and
  - Your GO ID number (from your previously issued ALDS fishing or hunting license). If you do not have a GO ID number, create a customer record [online](#) to obtain a GO ID number.
- A letter documenting your eligibility
  - Disabled Veterans must submit a letter from the Veteran's Administration. Visit the [U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs](#) website to obtain a copy of your VA Benefit Summary Letter that includes your character of discharge and combined service-connected evaluation rating.
  - Recovering Service Members must submit a letter from their Commanding Officer or a military doctor.
- Telephone number
- Email address (optional, but may expedite issuance)
- For hunting licenses only - proof of hunter education (Proof is not needed if you purchased a California hunting license after 2011. CDFW will have your hunter education on file.)

## Reduced-Fee Sport Fishing License for Low-Income Seniors (65 years or older) - Fee \$10.04

Fish and Game Code, Section 7150, authorizes CDFW to issue Reduced-Fee Sport Fishing Licenses to anglers who meet specific criteria. Additional validations or cards are required for certain species and must be purchased at the regular fee.

On October 7, 2021, Assembly Bill 817 was signed into law. This law changed the eligibility requirements for obtaining a reduced-fee sport fishing license for seniors with low income.

Effective January 1, 2022, any person 65 years of age or older who is a resident of California and receives benefits through Supplemental Security Income (SSI) pursuant to Section 12200 of the Welfare and Institutions Code or Cash Assistance Program for Aged, Blind, and Disabled Legal Immigrants (CAPI) pursuant to Chapter 10.3 (commencing with Section 18937) of Part 6 of Division 9 of the Welfare and Institutions Code is eligible for a reduced-fee sport fishing license. Verification from the Social Security Administration or Department of Social Services confirming your eligibility for SSI or CAPI is required annually.

### How to Apply for a Reduced-Fee Sport Fishing License for Low-Income Seniors

Reduced-Fee Sport Fishing Licenses that require Supplemental Security Income (SSI) or Cash Assistance Program for Aged, Blind, and Disabled Legal Immigrants (CAPI) verification must be renewed each year at a [CDFW License Sales Office](#).

[Print Reduced-Fee Sport Fishing License Application \(PDF\)](#)

## Free Sport Fishing Licenses



Fish and Game Code, Section 7151, authorizes the CDFW to issue Free Sport Fishing Licenses to anglers who meet specific criteria. Additional validations or cards are required for certain species and areas and must be purchased at the regular fee.

**Free Sport Fishing Licenses are available for anglers who meet ANY of these criteria:**

1. Any person, with central vision acuity of 20/200 or less in the better eye with the aid of the best possible correcting glasses, or central vision acuity better than 20/200 if the widest diameter of the remaining visual field is no greater than 20 degrees.  
Certification of blindness by an optometrist or an ophthalmologist is required. Any person who was issued this license under this criteria through ALDS may renew their licenses at any [CDFW license agent](#), [CDFW license sales office](#) or [online](#).  
[Print Free Sport Fishing License Application - Blind \(PDF\)](#)
2. Any person who is a resident of the State and who is so severely physically disabled as to be permanently unable to move from place to place without the aid of a wheelchair, walker, forearm crutches or a comparable mobility-related device. Verification by a licensed physician or a copy of the previous year's free fishing license is required. Any person who was issued this license under this criteria through ALDS may renew their licenses at any [CDFW license agent](#), [CDFW license sales office](#) or [online](#).  
[Print Free Sport Fishing License Application - Mobility Impaired \(PDF\)](#)
3. Any developmentally disabled person. Certification by a licensed physician or the director of a State regional center is required. Any person who was issued this license under this criteria through ALDS may renew their licenses at any [CDFW license agent](#), [CDFW license sales office](#) or [online](#).  
[Print Free Sport Fishing License Application - Developmentally Disabled \(PDF\)](#)
4. Any Native American who is a resident of the State and is financially unable to pay the fee required for a resident sport fishing license. Certification of tribal enrollment, a copy of the Certificate of Degree of Indian Blood, or a copy of an official tribal membership or identification card with membership number is required.  
[Print Free Sport Fishing License Application - Low Income Native Americans \(PDF\)](#)

## How to Apply for a Free Sport Fishing License

Complete the appropriate application above and follow the instructions to obtain your first license. All applications will be reviewed and eligibility will be verified prior to license issuance. Allow 15 business days for review and processing of your application. After your first free sport fishing license has been issued, if you qualify for the license based on disability, you may renew your license from any [CDFW license agent](#), at select [CDFW license sales offices](#) or [online](#).

Any Native American who has been issued a free low-income sport fishing license may renew their sport fishing license at select [CDFW license sales offices](#) or [online](#).

## Frequently Asked Questions

- > **365 - Day Sport Fishing Licenses**
- > **General Sport Fishing License Questions**
- > **Validations and Report Cards**
- > **Free and Reduced-Fee Licenses**
- > **General Information**

## Related Information

- [Free Fishing Days \(no license required\)](#)

- [License Sales Statistics](#)
- [Free Group Fishing Permit \(PDF\)](#) [↗](#)
- [Certificate of Nonreceipt / CNR \(PDF\)](#) [↗](#)
- [Declaration for Multi-Day Fishing Trip \(PDF\)](#) [↗](#)
- [Search For a Licensed Guide \(Fishing and Hunting\)](#) [↗](#)
- [Regulations](#)
- [SHARE Fishing Opportunities](#)

### License and Revenue Branch

P.O. Box 944209, Sacramento, CA 94244-2090 | [Sales Offices](#)  
 (916) 928-5805 | [LRB@wildlife.ca.gov](mailto:LRB@wildlife.ca.gov)

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